

Overnight No-Fuss Sourdough

Adjusted for 2 servings

Mix before bed, bake in the morning. No stretch & folds, no babysitting. Denser crumb than the classic method but great flavour and almost zero active time.

Ingredients

- 900 g bread flour
- 630 ml water (room temp)
- 100 g active sourdough starter (100% hydration)
- 18 g salt

Steps

1. Combine 900 g bread flour, 630 ml water (room temp), 100 g active sourdough starter (100% hydration), and 18 g salt in a large bowl. Mix until no dry flour remains — a few minutes by hand is enough. Dough will be shaggy, that's fine. Cover tightly.
2. Leave the covered bowl on the counter at room temperature overnight. 8–12 hours at ~20°C. It should roughly double and look bubbly on the surface.
3. Turn dough onto a lightly floured surface. It will be soft and sticky. Fold the edges toward the centre a few times, flip seam-side down, and use a bench scraper to drag it toward you to build some tension. Don't overwork it.
4. Place seam-side up in a floured banneton or lined bowl. Cover and rest at room temp while the oven preheats.
5. Put your Dutch oven (with lid) in the oven and heat to 500°F (260°C). Must be fully preheated before baking.
6. Tip dough onto parchment. Score with one confident slash. Lower into the hot Dutch oven using the parchment, cover, and bake for 20 minutes.
7. Remove lid, reduce to 450°F (230°C), and bake for 25 minutes until deep brown. Internal temp 96–98°C.

8. Cool on a wire rack for at least 1 hour before cutting.

Notes

Less starter = slower ferment. That's intentional — 50g gives you a long overnight window (8–12 hrs) without over-proofing. If your kitchen is cold (under 18°C), bump starter to 65g.

No banneton? A bowl lined with a well-floured tea towel works. Flour it heavily — rice flour is best if you have it, it doesn't absorb moisture and prevents sticking.

Crumb: Expect a tighter, more uniform crumb than the stretch-and-fold method. Perfectly good for toast and sandwiches. Not an Instagram loaf.

Over-proofed? If the dough looks very bubbly and slack in the morning, bake it immediately without the extra rest — don't let it go further.